

CloudTech Solutions

Customer Support Quality & Conduct Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes the mandatory standards, conduct requirements, and quality benchmarks for all customer support agents employed by CloudTech Solutions or its authorised partners. It applies to every customer-facing interaction — including telephone calls, live chat, email, video support, and remote desktop sessions — regardless of the channel, tier, or region.

CloudTech Solutions provides enterprise cloud infrastructure, SaaS platforms, managed IT services, cybersecurity solutions, and 24/7 technical support. The quality of every customer interaction directly reflects our brand promise: *Reliable technology, delivered with care.*

2. Call Opening Standards

2.1 Mandatory Greeting Script

Every call must begin with the following elements within the first 10 seconds:

Step	Required Element	Example Phrase
1	Brand identification	"Thank you for calling CloudTech Solutions."
2	Agent name	"My name is [First Name]."
3	Offer to help	"How may I assist you today?"

2.2 Identity Verification (MANDATORY)

Before accessing, modifying, or discussing any account information, the agent **MUST** verify the customer's identity using at least **TWO** of the following authentication factors:

- Full registered name and email address
- Account reference number or contract ID
- Date of birth (for consumer accounts)
- Last four digits of the registered payment method
- One-time verification code sent to the registered mobile number

Failure to perform identity verification before account access is a Tier 1 disciplinary offence.

3. Communication Standards

3.1 Language and Tone

Agents must maintain a calm, professional, and empathetic tone at all times. The following language standards are mandatory in every interaction:

Category	Required	Prohibited
Tone	Warm, confident, solution-oriented	Dismissive, impatient, sarcastic
Language	Clear standard English (or agreed local language)	Slang, jargon, profanity, abbreviations
Customer address	"Mr/Ms [Surname]" or "[First Name]" as preferred	"Mate", "Buddy", "Love", "Guys"
Holds	"May I place you on a brief hold while I investigate?"	Silent hold without permission
Transfers	"I'll connect you with a specialist who can best assist you."	Blind transfers without briefing

3.2 Empathy Statements

Agents must demonstrate empathy when a customer expresses frustration or reports a service impact. At least one empathy statement must be used when the customer describes a problem:

- *"I completely understand how frustrating this must be for you."*
- *"I sincerely apologise for the inconvenience this has caused."*
- *"I can see why that would be concerning, and I'm going to resolve this for you now."*

3.3 Active Listening

Agents must not interrupt the customer while they are speaking. Agents must use verbal affirmations to signal they are listening (e.g., "I understand", "Of course", "Absolutely"). Agents must paraphrase the customer's issue back to them to confirm understanding before proposing any solution.

4. Technical Support Standards

4.1 Tier Escalation Matrix

Issue Type	Initial Tier	Escalate After	Escalate To
Billing queries	Tier 1	5 minutes unresolved	Billing Specialist
Account access / lockouts	Tier 1	First contact if MFA failure	Identity & Access Team
Cloud infrastructure – performance	Tier 2	15 min without resolution path	Platform Engineering (24/7)
Security incident / data breach	Tier 2	Immediate	Security Operations Centre
SLA breach notification	Tier 2	Immediate	Account Manager + Tier 3
Outage (P1 incident)	Tier 3	Immediate page	Incident Commander on-call

4.2 Cloud Service Terminology

Agents must use correct terminology when discussing CloudTech products. The following terms must never be misrepresented:

- **SLA (Service Level Agreement)** — Agents must know the customer's contracted uptime SLA and quote it accurately.
- **RTO / RPO** — Recovery Time Objective and Recovery Point Objective must not be quoted from memory; always retrieve from the contract system.
- **Regions and Availability Zones** — Never guess geographic redundancy details; use the infrastructure dashboard.
- **Data residency** — Agents must not make verbal commitments about where data is stored without written confirmation from a Data Privacy Officer.

5. Prohibited Conduct

The following behaviours are strictly prohibited and may result in immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment:

P1 – Immediate Dismissal

- Sharing customer credentials, account data, or confidential system information with unauthorised parties
- Bypassing identity verification procedures
- Accessing customer accounts without a valid support ticket or customer consent
- Making false statements to customers about service status, pricing, or capabilities
- Recording calls for personal use or sharing call recordings outside authorised systems

P2 – Formal Warning + Retraining

- Using profanity, abusive, discriminatory, or unparliamentary language
- Promising unauthorised discounts, free service extensions, or SLA credits without manager approval
- Abandoning a call without resolution, escalation, or clear follow-up commitment
- Discussing competitor products or making comparative claims
- Using personal devices to handle customer data

P3 – Verbal Warning

- Failing to use the mandatory greeting script
- Placing customer on hold for more than 2 minutes without check-in
- Closing a ticket without customer confirmation that the issue is resolved
- Failing to log accurate call notes within 5 minutes of call end

6. Call Closure Standards

Every call must close with all of the following steps completed:

- **Summarise resolution:** Restate what was resolved or what next steps have been agreed.
- **Confirm satisfaction:** Ask "Have I fully resolved your issue today?" and document the response.
- **Provide reference number:** Always give the customer a ticket or case reference number.
- **Set expectations:** If the issue is unresolved, give a specific time and contact method for follow-up.
- **Close professionally:** End with "Thank you for contacting CloudTech Support. Have a great day."

Do not end the call before the customer has confirmed they are ready to disconnect.

7. Quality Scoring Framework

All calls are subject to quality analysis and scoring. Agents are evaluated on the following 10 dimensions, each scored 0–10:

Metric	Weight	Description	Minimum Score
Empathy	12%	Demonstrates understanding of customer emotion and impact	6.0
Resolution	15%	Issue fully resolved or clear escalation path established	7.0
Communication	12%	Clear, correct, jargon-free language at appropriate pace	6.5
Professionalism	10%	Tone, conduct, and adherence to language standards	7.0
Customer Satisfaction	12%	Predicted and actual customer satisfaction with the interaction	6.0
Product Knowledge	10%	Accuracy of technical information and product details	6.5
Listening	8%	Active listening, no interruptions, correct paraphrasing	6.0
Response Time	8%	Time to first meaningful response and time to resolution	5.5
First Call Resolution	8%	Issue resolved without requiring a follow-up contact	6.0
Compliance	5%	Adherence to verification, GDPR, and prohibited conduct rules	8.0

7.1 Rating Thresholds

Rating	Overall Score	Consequence
Excellent	8.5 – 10.0	Eligible for performance bonus; used as training exemplar
Good	7.0 – 8.4	Standard performance; no action required
Average	5.5 – 6.9	Coaching session required within 5 business days
Poor	Below 5.5	Formal performance improvement plan; retraining mandatory

8. Data Protection and Confidentiality

8.1 GDPR / Data Privacy Requirements

- Agents must not read personal data aloud in a shared workspace where it could be overheard.
- Screen shares during remote support must exclude all non-relevant windows and applications.
- Customer data must never be stored on personal devices, printed, or emailed to non-corporate addresses.
- Any suspected data breach must be reported to the Data Protection Officer within 1 hour of discovery.

8.2 Call Recording Notice

Agents must inform customers at the start of every call: *"This call may be recorded for quality and training purposes."* This statement must be delivered before any account information is discussed.

9. SLA Commitments by Product Tier

Product / Service	Tier	Response SLA	Resolution SLA	Availability
CloudCore Infrastructure	Platinum	15 minutes	4 hours	99.99%
Managed Cloud Hosting	Gold	30 minutes	8 hours	99.95%
SaaS Platform (Enterprise)	Gold	30 minutes	8 hours	99.95%
SaaS Platform (Business)	Silver	2 hours	24 hours	99.9%
IT Support Managed Services	Gold	1 hour	4 hours	99.9%
Cybersecurity SOC	Platinum	5 minutes (P1)	2 hours (P1)	99.99%
Developer API	Silver	4 hours	48 hours	99.9%
General Technical Support	Bronze	Next business day	5 business days	99.5%

10. Policy Acknowledgement and Review

All customer support agents must read this policy in full, complete the associated online assessment (minimum 80% pass mark), and sign the acknowledgement form within 5 business days of onboarding or of any major policy revision.

This policy is reviewed quarterly by the Head of Customer Experience, the Chief Compliance Officer, and the VP of Engineering. Amendments are communicated via the internal policy portal with a minimum 10 business days' notice before the effective date.

Approved by	Role	Signature	Date
Alex Carter	Chief Executive Officer	_____	01 Mar 2026
Jordan Patel	VP Customer Experience	_____	01 Mar 2026
Sam Okonkwo	Chief Compliance Officer	_____	01 Mar 2026